

2. Perf Testing: Tools, Setup & Access

Your one-stop onboarding and KT guide to get up and running with Performance QA



Page is about?

This Page Will:

- Be the **central hub** for all tooling and setup
- Link to external tools, login portals, repos, and credentials (secured)
- Cover local setup + cloud/deployment flow
- Serve as **internal wiki** for all **infra/platform dependencies**

1. Core Tools List

Tool	Purpose	Install/Access Link
JMeter	Load test scripting	Install Guide Install plugin manager: https://jmeter-plugins.org/wiki/PluginsManager/ a. Install plugins i. Custom JMeter Functions ii. Parallel Controller & Sampler
Taurus	YAML-based test orchestration	JMeter Docs
BlazeMeter	Cloud execution / dashboards	BlazeMeter Installation pip install bzt
Jenkins	CI Test execution	https://jenkins.ascensus.com
Kubernetes (kubectl)	Infra deployment	K8s Install Guide <i>Note: Place the kubectl.exe wherever you like but make sure to add its folder to the PATH environment variable</i>
Rancher/K8s	Env monitoring & Cluster management	Rancher Login
GitLab	Repositories for YAML/JMX /scripts	GitLab Repos
Postman	API testing	Postman Installation

2. Local Setup Instructions (CLI + IDE)

Install Dependencies

- Java 11+
- Python 3.x + pip
- Node.js (for Postman)
- Git CLI
- VS Code/IntelliJ IDEA or Eclipse

Taurus Setup (Local)

Taurus
<pre>pip install bzt bzt examples/test.yml</pre>

JMeter Setup

- Download GUI from jmeter.apache.org
- Use .jmx files from GitLab
- Validate configs with `bzt jmeter.yaml`

1. GitLab `performance-universal`, `astro-test`, `unite-performance`
2. Run smoke test in JMeter / Taurus
3. Validate YAML configs (`plan.yaml`, `spike.yaml`)
1. `cd ~/performance-tests` (Navigate to Folder you would like to run the test)
2. `bzt smoke.yaml`
3. Review results on console or export HTML

3. Access Requests & Permissions

System	Access Method	Notes
Rancher	Fresh Service Ticket	Ask for `ags-qa` access; reference Swapnil/Nick
New Relic	Email Rimma Guberman (rimma.guberman@ascensus.com)	New Relic Login
Jenkins	QA Admin to add user	Ping DevOps
GitLab	Create account via Okta SSO	Request access to performance - testing repos
BlazeMeter	Auto-create via email login	enter your email, SSO will automatically create an account in Blazemeter. (Do not click using SAML link)
Kubernetes	Get kubeconfig via Rancher	Place in `C:\Users\<user>\.kube\config`

4. Jenkins Integration (CI/CD Flow)

- Login to [Jenkins](https://jenkins.ascensus.com) (<https://jenkins.ascensus.com>)
- Select prebuilt job (e.g., Astro Load Test)
- Input branch/YAML
- Run View console logs

```
bzt jmeter_loadtest.yaml
```

1. Use existing JMX or YAML
2. Add to performance pipeline folder
3. Configure input vars (threads, env, hold-for)
4. Link results to Confluence/Test Report page

5. Folder Structure – GitLab / Test Repos

```
performance
  universal
  |   metadata
  |       jmeter/
  |           login_test.jmx
  |           login_test-local.yaml
  |           login_test-remote.yaml
  |           login_test.csv
  |       taurus/
  |           load.yaml
  |   account
  |       jmeter/
  |           dashboard_test.jmx
  |           dashboard_test-local.yaml
  |           dashboard_test-remote.yaml
  |           dashboard_test.csv
  |       taurus/
  |           load.yaml
  setup
  qc4.properties
  stage1.properties
  base_taurus.yaml
```

Follow naming convention: `app_env_users_testtype_date.yaml`

6. Credential Handling

Credentials are **never stored in scripts**
Use Jenkins vaults or runtime config parameters.

Credential	How to Manage
DB User	Ask DB Admin via RT
API Token (BlazeMeter)	User Profile Generate Token
Kubernetes Config	Download via Rancher ags-qa namespace
Jenkins Vars	Use vault-safe injection or <code>*.env</code> properties

Never hardcode credentials in YAMLs or scripts. Use token/env injection.

7. Cleanup & Post-Test Practices

Area	Action
BlazeMeter	Archive test artifacts after each run, see the recommendations below
GitLab	Push final reports & YAML with timestamp
Test Data	Remove from QA env unless reuse planned, see the recommendations below
NR Dashboard Tags	Remove temp filters or test markers

- Delete unused test projects weekly
- Archive reports to GitLab or shared drive
- Use tag naming: Q2-2025, Astro-Soak
- Reset test users, sessions post test
- Scripts: ``/scripts/cleanup.sql``, ``delete-users.yaml``

Best Practices

- Always run `bzt plan.yaml --validate` before execution
- Never test production without sign-off + CAB
- Use New Relic for live monitoring, **not JMeter UI**
- Run **baseline tests before stress/soak/load**
- Label tests properly: `app_env_users_testtype_date`
- Store reports in both Confluence + GitLab

Summary

This page becomes your team's **"run-this-first" wiki** whenever someone sets up tools or infra. It prevents duplicate setups, errors, and "How do I...?" messages every week.